



# 82%

**OF MEN ARE LOOKING  
FOR A MATE BY THEM-  
SELVES ON THE NET**

primary virtue is beauty, are fixated on caste and horoscope-matching, or are overly ambitious. "She must be honest, independent and her own person, not propped up by parental guidance," he says. And, most importantly, he should be able to "hold a conversation with her".

We love to put the modern Indian woman under the scanner. We count the ways she has arrived. We obsess over what she wants. We analyse her life in the light of the new laws and the logic of the marriage market and love to award the "achiever". But rarely do we talk about her "significant other": how the average Indian man looks at her; what he expects out of the holy institution of matrimony and who he considers a "suitable girl". All that and more come out in a partner preference survey conducted by Shaadi.com, one of India's top matrimonial sites, on 11,577 individuals across 300 Indian cities, towns and included NRIs as well (26 per cent). And the statistics reveal a world of difficult choices, where men seem to have resolved some of their life issues. Through it all, a new sensibility seems to be emerging, along with a restless quest toward sexual equality. The plot and characters in the battle of the sexes

# 50%

**OF MEN HAVE NO REAL  
PREFERENCE FOR  
FAIR-SKINNED GIRLS**

# 41%

**OF MEN WANT QUALITY  
TIME TOGETHER TO  
GET TO KNOW A  
PROSPECTIVE  
PARTNER BETTER**

